🇮🇱 ISRAEL WARTIME PREPAREDNESS: FIELD GUIDE & CHECKLISTS

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** This is not an official government resource. See Disclaimer at end of document. Based on HFC (Pikud HaOref) published guidance. Official source: oref.org.il*

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1. How To Use This Document

1.1 Preparation (Before Emergencies)

Print and prepare this checklist before you need it. Do not wait for a siren to figure out what to do. During routine periods:

- Print multiple copies on durable paper (or laminate if possible)

- **Affix a strip of reflective tape** to the cover or top edge — this makes it visible when swept with a torch in the dark
- **Bind or staple** the pages together. A simple document folder or plastic sleeve works well. The goal is a single grab-and-go item, not loose pages
- Prepare at least **3 copies** and store them in these locations:
  - On the fridge or by the front door (the working copy)
  - In the go bag
  - In the mamad / protected space
- **Review and reprint** whenever the checklist is updated or when items become outdated (expired supplies, changed shelter locations, etc.)

1.2 Running The Checklist

Two-person method (recommended). One person reads each item aloud. The other physically verifies it and responds (e.g. "CHECK", "DONE", "NOT YET"). Alternate roles periodically to avoid fatigue. This is the same challenge-and-response method used in aviation and military checklists — it catches items that a single person scanning alone will miss. If alone, read each item aloud to yourself and physically verify before moving on.

CHECKLIST	WHEN TO RUN
Full Master Checklist (Section 3)	At the start of any escalation or war · After returning from evacuation · Weekly during sustained conflict
Quick Smoke Test — PAWS BED (Section 2)	Daily during wartime · Weekly during elevated tension · Monthly during routine
Situational Checklists (Section 4)	Every time, during wartime or escalation

Items marked ⚠️ are critical — do not skip these under any circumstances.

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2. Quick Smoke Test — "PAWS BED"

Periodic rapid readiness check. Can be completed in under 2 minutes.

#	CHECK	VERIFY
P	**Phone**	On, charged, HFC app running, correct alert area
A	**Alerts**	Wireless emergency alerts enabled, DND override verified

#	CHECK	VERIFY
W	**Water**	72-hour supply accessible and not expired
S	**Shelter**	Nearest 3 shelters known, routes walkable
B	**Bag**	Go bag by door, zipped, contents verified
E	**Exit**	Hallway clear, door unlockable quickly
D	**Dependents**	All household members present or accounted for

> **Mnemonic: PAWS BED** — "*Check your PAWS before BED*"

3. Master Checklist

3.1 Technical Systems & Alerts

ITEM	CHECK
Smartphone ⚠️	☐ **ON PERSON** or LOCATION KNOWN ☐ **BATTERY LEVEL** - OK or CHARGING (🌙)
Smartphone - Configuration ⚠️	☐ **POWERED ON** *(DND okay; airplane mode not okay)* ☐ **LOCATION SERVICES** - ENABLED **HOME FRONT COMMAND APP:** ☐ INSTALLED ☐ CONFIGURED (SEE APPENDIX A) ☐ RUNNING ☐ CORRECT ALERT AREA - VALIDATED **EMERGENCY WIRELESS ALERTS** ☐ ACTIVATED - Ensure 'Extreme' threats are alerting
Computer	Red Alert app for browser is: ☐ **ACTIVE** ☐ **CORRECT LOCATION** is SET ☐ **TESTED** and **VALIDATED WORKING**

3.2 Home Environment

ITEM	CHECK
Water ⚠️	☐ **72 HOURS SUPPLY** - READY and ACCESSIBLE *(Calc 3L/Person/Day)* and RESUPPLIED when necessary
Food ⚠️	☐ **PANTRY GOODS** - STOCKED and RESUPPLIED when necessary
Torch	☐ **ACCESSIBLE** - HAND CRANK OR BATTERY WITH RESERVE
Hallway ⚠️	☐ **CLEAR** (No obstructions)
Fire Extinguisher	☐ **ACCESSIBLE** ☐ **SMOKE DETECTOR** - installed and tested

ITEM	CHECK
Heavy Furniture	☐ **BOOKCASES / SHELVES** secured to walls ☐ **APPLIANCE WHEELS** locked ☐ **HEAVY OBJECTS** stored low, not above head height
Gas / Electricity ⚠️	☐ **SHUTOFF LOCATIONS KNOWN** by all household members ☐ **ALL MEMBERS** know how and when to shut off
Escape Routes	☐ **PRIMARY EXIT** identified ☐ **SECONDARY EXIT** identified *(back door, porch, emergency stairs)* ☐ **ROUTES CLEAR** of obstacles
Baby Carry	☐ **BY FRONT DOOR**
Mamad	☐ **PREPARED** (SEE APPENDIX C - MAMAD INSPECTION)

3.3 Go Bag

See Section 5.1 for guidance on choosing a suitable bag.

ITEM	CHECK
Prepared ⚠️	☐ **BY DOOR** ☐ **ZIPPED/SEALED**
Contents (Basic) ⚠️	☐ **Phone charger and cable** - PACKED ☐ **Power bank** - PACKED and LEVEL VERIFIED or CHARGING (🌙) ☐ **Medications** ☐ Essential meds - PACKED ☐ Essential meds - SUPPLY CHECKED and REPLENISHED when possible and if necessary ☐ **Torch** - INSIDE and CHARGED ☐ **N95** - PACKED (one/person)
Contents (Additionals)	☐ Emergency **Whistle** - PACKED ☐ **AM/FM Radio** - PACKED and BATTERY or CHARGE OK ☐ **First Aid Kit** - PACKED and SUPPLIED ☐ **Travel router** - PACKED
Contents *(Per Preference For Overnight Stays In Public Shelters)*	☐ **RELIGIOUS EFFECTS** - PACKED (SIDDUR, TEFILIN) ☐ **FOOD/DRINK** - PACKED (FOR LONGER STAYS) ☐ **EYE MASK** AND **EARPLUGS** - PACKED if sleeping in and safe ☐ **BEER/WINE OPENERS** ☐ **WATER BOTTLES** ☐ **UMBRELLAS** ☐ **TRAVEL ROUTER + ETHERNET CABLE + AC SUPPLY** ☐ **PLUG ADAPTERS/SPLITTERS** ☐ TENT / BLANKET
Travel Docs *(Per Preference)*	☐ **PASSPORTS** - PACKED and VALIDATED ☐ **CASH** - ON HAND / PACKED ☐ **NATIONAL IDS** - PACKED ☐ **TRAVEL DOCS** - PACKED

3.4 People & Dependents

ITEM	CHECK
Dependents ⚠️	All household members: ☐ **PRESENT** or ☐ **ACCOUNTED FOR** and **CONTACTABLE**

3.5 Babies & Young Children

ITEM	CHECK
Essential Supplies ⚠️	PACKED in Go Bag: ☐ Diapers ☐ Wipes ☐ Pacifier ☐ Formula ☐ Bottle ☐ Changing mat + privacy
Ready To Go ⚠️	☐ CLOTHED or CLOTHES BY BED ☐ BABYWEAR by door ☐ FED (if needed) ☐ CLEANED (if needed)

3.6 Person & Personal Effects

ITEM	☀️ DAYTIME	🌙 NIGHT-TIME
Clothing ⚠️	☐ **DRESSED** - For weather	☐ **BY DOOR** or **BY BED** or **SLEEPING IN**
Footwear ⚠️	☐ **WEARING** - Closed toe footwear	☐ **BY DOOR** or **BY BED** - Closed toe footwear
Keys ⚠️	☐ **ON PERSON** or **BY DOOR**	
Wallet		
Meds	☐ **TAKEN** on schedule	
Rest	☐ **TAKEN** when possible	
Hygiene	☐ **TENDED TO** as soon as possible	
Toilet Visits	☐ **TAKEN** as soon as possible	

3.7 Situational Awareness

CATEGORY	ACTIONS	FREQUENCY
NEWS UPDATES	☐ SCANNED	*Every 1 to 3 hours, prioritising official/gov sources*

CATEGORY	ACTIONS	FREQUENCY
ALERTING AREA	☐ KNOWN	
PUBLIC SHELTERS	☐ NEAREST 3 SHELTERS KNOWN ☐ ACCESSIBILITY VERIFIED ☐ SHELTER IS OPEN ☐ HOURS NOTED ☐ EXIT TIMED AND PROCEDURE AGREED	*Once per emergency*
HOME FRONT COMMAND	☐ APP CHECKED - To familiarise with current advice	*Once per day during emergencies/ wars*
SUPPLY MAINTENANCE	☐ WATER + FOOD replaced ☐ BATTERIES + ELECTRONICS checked	*Water/food: every 3 months. Batteries/ electronics: every 6 months.*

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4. Situational Checklists

4.1 Daytime At-Home Posture (Wartime)

Quick status check while at home during the day. Run after waking, and repeat after any disruption to routine.

ITEM	CHECK
Phone ⚠️	☐ **ON PERSON** or within arm's reach ☐ **CHARGED** or charging ☐ **HFC APP RUNNING**
Dressed ⚠️	☐ **FULLY CLOTHED** ☐ **CLOSED-TOE SHOES ON** *(not slippers, not barefoot)*
Keys ⚠️	☐ **ON PERSON** or in door / by door
Go Bag ⚠️	☐ **BY DOOR** ☐ **ZIPPED**
Exit Route ⚠️	☐ **HALLWAY CLEAR** ☐ **FRONT DOOR** can be opened quickly
Browser Alert	☐ **RED ALERT EXTENSION ACTIVE** on computer *(if working at desk)*

Working from home during wartime:

You will have gaps between alerts where you can be productive. Use them, but do not let work compromise your readiness.

- **Stay dressed and shoed.** Do not slip into pyjamas because you're "just at the desk"
- **Keep your go bag by the door**, not moved aside to make room
- **Headphones:** Use one ear only, or keep volume low enough to hear a siren. Open-back headphones or speakers are better than noise-cancelling earbuds
- **Video calls:** At the start of any meeting with people outside the security situation, state your situation briefly. Suggested message:

> *"I'm currently in an active alert zone in Israel. I may need to leave this call abruptly if a siren sounds. I'll rejoin as soon as it's safe."*

- **Notify your team / manager** once at the start of the escalation. Suggested message:

> *"Letting you know that we're under active rocket alerts in my area. I'm working from home but may go offline without warning during sirens. I'll update you when I can. Please don't wait on me for time-sensitive decisions during this period."*

- **Save work frequently.** You may need to abandon your desk mid-sentence
- **Do not use the security situation as background noise** — if you find yourself ignoring alerts or not reacting to sirens because you're focused on work, stop working and reset your posture

4.2 After Returning From Shelter (Reset)

Run this immediately after the all-clear. The goal is to restore full readiness before the next alert. This is when preparation degrades — resist the urge to relax everything at once.

ITEM	CHECK
Go Bag ⚠️	☐ **BACK BY DOOR** ☐ **RE-ZIPPED** - Did anything fall out or get removed? Put it back now
Phone ⚠️	☐ **PUT ON CHARGE** if battery dropped ☐ **HFC APP** still running
Power Bank	☐ **PUT ON CHARGE** - It may have been used in shelter
Water	☐ **RESUPPLY** if you drank from your emergency stock

ITEM	CHECK
Clothes & Shoes	☐ **BACK IN POSITION** - By bed (night) or on person (day)
Torch	☐ **BACK IN POSITION** - Nightstand or go bag
Dependents ⚠️	☐ **ALL ACCOUNTED FOR** and safe
Self-Care (You) ⚠️	☐ **DRINK WATER** ☐ **EAT** if you can ☐ **USE THE TOILET** ☐ **SHOWER** if time and situation allow ☐ **REST** when possible - *Do these NOW, not later. You don't know when the next alert comes. Take care of yourself between alerts the way you would between shifts.*
Self-Care (Children) ⚠️	☐ **FED** ☐ **WATERED** ☐ **TOILETED / CHANGED** ☐ **CLEANED** if possible ☐ **RESTED** - put down for a nap if timing allows - *Children cannot manage their own recovery. Prioritise their needs immediately after the all-clear, while the situation is calm.*
News Check	☐ **BRIEF SCAN** of official sources - Is the situation ongoing? Adjust posture accordingly

4.3 Before Showering (Wartime)

ITEM	CHECK
News Check ⚠️	☐ **SITUATION SCANNED** - No active alerts or imminent threat in your area
Phone ⚠️	☐ **VOLUME AT MAXIMUM** - Must be audible over running water ☐ **IN BATHROOM** or just outside door
Clothes ⚠️	☐ **FULL OUTFIT IN BATHROOM** - Ready to throw on immediately *(not in another room)*
Footwear ⚠️	☐ **CLOSED-TOE SHOES** by bathroom door
Towel	☐ **WITHIN REACH** - For rapid dry-off
Door	☐ **BATHROOM DOOR UNLOCKED**
Keep It Short ⚠️	☐ **MINIMISE TIME** - You are at your most vulnerable; be quick

4.4 Before Bed (Nighttime Posture)

ITEM	CHECK
News Check	☐ **SITUATION SCANNED** - Assess if safe to sleep at home tonight
Phone ⚠️	

ITEM	CHECK
	☐ **CHARGING** or charged ☐ **NOT IN AIRPLANE MODE** *(DND/silent OK - alert apps override)* ☐ **LOCATION SERVICES ON** ☐ **HFC APP** has notification + override permissions
Clothes ⚠️	☐ **LAID OUT BY BED** - Full outfit ready to throw on in seconds
Footwear ⚠️	☐ **CLOSED-TOE SHOES BY BED** - Ready to step into immediately
Torch	☐ **WITHIN ARM'S REACH** - On nightstand, not buried in go bag
Glasses	☐ **BY BED** *(if needed)* - Same spot every night
Keys	☐ **ACCESSIBLE** - By bed or on hook by front door
Go Bag ⚠️	☐ **BY DOOR** ☐ **CONTENTS VERIFIED** ☐ **POWER BANK** on charge
Exit Route ⚠️	☐ **HALLWAY CLEAR** - Can navigate in the dark without tripping ☐ **FRONT DOOR** can be opened quickly *(not double-locked)*
Hearing ⚠️	☐ **NO EARPLUGS** - You must hear the siren and phone alert
Dependents ⚠️	☐ **ALL ACCOUNTED FOR** ☐ **BABY** - clothed or clothes by bed, babywear by door

4.5 Before Leaving Home (Wartime)

ITEM	CHECK
Go Bag ⚠️	☐ **TAKING WITH YOU**
News Check ⚠️	☐ **SITUATION SCANNED** before departure - Check HFC app and news for active alerts or escalation in your route/destination area
Shelters At Destination ⚠️	☐ **NEAREST SHELTERS IDENTIFIED** at destination and along route
Time To Shelter	☐ **KNOWN** for destination area *(check HFC Alerts tab at oref.org.il)*
Phone ⚠️	☐ **CHARGED** ☐ **HFC APP RUNNING** ☐ **LOCATION SERVICES ON**
Car Fuel	☐ **AT LEAST HALF A TANK**
Household Notified	☐ **DESTINATION AND EXPECTED RETURN** communicated to household members

5. Guidance Notes

5.1 Choosing a Go Bag

Your go bag is the single most important physical item in your readiness kit. A poor bag choice undermines everything inside it. Choose carefully.

Use a backpack, not a tote bag, handbag, or shopping bag. The reason is simple: you need both hands free. You may be carrying a child, holding a torch, opening doors, navigating stairs in the dark, or helping someone else. A shoulder bag or tote slips, swings, and requires a hand to hold. A backpack stays on your back and leaves you free to move.

What to look for:

- **Two shoulder straps** with padding — must sit comfortably when loaded
- **Chest strap and/or waist strap** — prevents bouncing and shifting when running
- **Water-resistant material** — you may be outside in rain; a full waterproof bag is better but not essential
- **30–40 litre capacity** — large enough for 72-hour essentials, small enough to move quickly with
- **Multiple compartments** — you need to find things in the dark by feel, not dump everything out. Medications, torch, and phone charger should have known, consistent pockets
- **Durable zips** — the bag will be grabbed, thrown, and dragged. Cheap zips fail at the worst time
- **Dark or neutral colour** — visibility is not the goal here; the reflective tape on your checklist and on the bag handles that

What to avoid:

- Tote bags, drawstring bags, single-strap sling bags — anything that requires a hand to carry or stay on your shoulder
- Wheeled luggage — useless on stairs, rubble, or wet ground
- Very large bags (60L+ hiking packs) — too heavy and slow when loaded; this is not a camping trip
- Fashion bags or anything with no structure — collapses when set down, hard to pack consistently

Once selected:

- Affix a strip of **reflective tape** to the straps or front panel
- Assign each item a **fixed pocket/location** and always return it there
- Keep it **by the front door**, not in a closet or bedroom
- Every household member should know where it is and what is in it

5.2 In Shelter — When To Leave

Wait for the all-clear. Do NOT leave your protected space until you receive an all-clear notification from HFC (via the app, official media, or the all-clear siren pattern).

If you have no connectivity (phone dead, no signal, no internet):

- **Stay in shelter.** The default action when you have no information is to remain in place
- Do NOT assume the situation is over because it has been quiet for a few minutes
- If you have a battery-powered or hand-crank radio, tune to a national station for updates
- If you have no radio, wait for someone with connectivity to confirm the all-clear, or wait until you hear clear activity from neighbours leaving their shelters
- **When in doubt, stay longer.** Leaving too early is far more dangerous than staying too long

Many casualties occur because people leave shelter prematurely. If you cannot confirm the all-clear, do not move.

5.3 In Shelter — Behaviour

Children:

- Use a calm, steady voice. Children take their cues from adults — if you are calm, they will be calmer
- Explain simply: "We're in our safe room. We wait here until we're told it's safe"
- Have a comfort item ready (keep one in the mamad and one in the go bag)
- Distraction helps: a colouring book, small game, or familiar song
- Hold young children close. Physical contact is reassuring
- Do not lie ("nothing is happening") — children can hear sirens. Acknowledge it simply and redirect to the plan

General:

- Sit against an inner wall, below window line. Do not stand near windows, doors, or exterior walls
- Do NOT use elevators during or after an alert
- Do NOT go outside to look at the sky or photograph interceptions — falling debris is the primary cause of civilian injuries
- Keep the mamad/shelter door closed until the all-clear
- If you smell gas or see structural damage after an impact, move to an alternative shelter and call 102 (Fire & Rescue)
- After the all-clear, send a brief message to family confirming you are safe — keep it short to avoid overloading networks

- Do not spread unverified information about what you saw or heard. Wait for official sources

5.4 Moving Safely to a Public Shelter

The journey to shelter is one of the most dangerous moments — many injuries happen not from the threat itself but from falls, collisions, and panic on the way to safety.

Before you move:

- Know where you're going. Hesitation in a stairwell costs seconds you don't have
- Grab your go bag only if it's directly on the route. Do not backtrack for it
- If carrying a child, secure them first, then move

On the stairs:

- **Hold the handrail.** Wet stairs, dark stairwells, and socks on tile are a fall waiting to happen
- Do NOT run down stairs — move at a fast, controlled walk. A broken ankle in the stairwell is worse than arriving 3 seconds later
- Stay to one side if others are also moving — traffic flows faster in a single direction
- If you are above others, do not push. If you are below and hear someone fall, stop and help if time allows

Outside:

- **Watch the ground.** Broken glass, uneven pavement, tree roots, kerbs — you may be in the dark
- Do NOT run across roads without looking. Cars may still be moving
- Wear closed-toe shoes. Running to shelter barefoot or in sandals is how people cut their feet on debris
- If you cannot reach shelter in time, enter the nearest solid building or lie flat — do NOT keep running in the open

At the shelter door:

- Do not crowd the entrance. Let people with children, elderly, and mobility-limited individuals enter first
- Once inside, move away from the door to make room for others
- Do not block the entrance with bags or bodies

Common injuries on the way to shelter:

- Falls on stairs (especially wet, dark, or in socks)
- Tripping on uneven ground outside
- Cuts from bare feet on glass/debris

- Collisions with other people or furniture in narrow hallways
- Panic-related sprains from running too fast on stairs

5.5 Waking Up to a Night Alarm

This is one of the hardest scenarios. You are groggy, disoriented, possibly in total darkness. Your reaction time is degraded and your decision-making is impaired. Everything in Section 4.4 (Before Bed) exists to make this moment survivable on autopilot.

The first 5 seconds:

1. **Siren or phone alert wakes you.** Do not try to process what is happening. Just move
2. **Feet on floor → into shoes.** This is why they are right by the bed, same spot every night
3. **Grab glasses** (same spot, every night) and **phone** (it's right there, charging)

The next 10–20 seconds: 4. **Clothes:** If you sleep in clothes (recommended during high escalation), skip this. Otherwise, pull on whatever is laid out. Speed over appearance — a t-shirt and tracksuit bottoms are fine 5. **Grab torch** from nightstand if power is out 6. **Move to protected space** or front door (for shelter). The hallway is clear because you checked before bed. The door is not double-locked because you checked before bed

For parents: 7. One parent goes to the child/children. The other grabs the go bag (pre-assigned roles — Section 5.3) 8. Carry the baby in the babywear that's by the door. Do not stop to dress the baby — wrap them in whatever is on them

Key principles:

- **Do not think. Follow the procedure.** Every decision you have to make in the dark at 3am is a decision you should have made before bed
- **Do not check your phone for details.** The siren means go. Read the details in the shelter
- **Torch before lights.** If the power is out, you need the torch. If it's on, lights help — but don't waste time looking for a switch
- **It gets easier.** After 2–3 night alarms, the routine becomes automatic. The first one is the hardest

5.6 Fighting Alert Fatigue

After days or weeks of alerts, the temptation to stop reacting properly is enormous. You start to rationalise: "It's probably nothing." "It won't land here." "I'll just stay on the sofa." This is alert fatigue, and it kills people.

Why it happens:

- Repeated exposure to the same stimulus reduces your response — this is a normal neurological process, not a character flaw
- Most alerts end without personal impact, which reinforces the (false) belief that sheltering is unnecessary
- Fatigue, stress, and disrupted sleep further degrade your motivation to move
- Social pressure: if you see neighbours not sheltering, you feel permission to stop too

How to fight it:

- **Reframe every alert as the first one.** The one you skip could be the one that matters. There is no way to know in advance
- **Use the checklist mechanically.** This is exactly what checklists are for — they work when your judgment doesn't. Run PAWS BED even when it feels pointless
- **Keep your shoes on.** The single biggest predictor of whether someone will shelter is whether they have to get dressed first. Stay ready
- **Lower the effort, not the standard.** If you're exhausted, sleep in your clothes by the door. That's not giving up — that's adapting while maintaining protection
- **Talk about it.** Tell your household: "I'm feeling alert fatigue. Let's make a pact to keep going to shelter." Accountability helps
- **Remember the statistics.** Civilian injuries spike in the second and third week of conflicts, when alert fatigue peaks. The threat doesn't decrease because you're tired of it
- **If you truly cannot bring yourself to move** to a shelter, at minimum: get away from windows, sit against an inner wall, protect your head. Partial compliance is better than nothing

5.7 Wellness During Protracted Conflict

Wars lasting weeks or months create cumulative physical and psychological strain that is different from the acute stress of a single event. Readiness includes taking care of yourself.

Physical:

- **Sleep when you can.** Do not try to maintain a normal schedule. Sleep in shifts if possible. Any sleep is better than no sleep. If you can nap for 20 minutes between alerts, take it
- **Eat regular meals.** Stress suppresses appetite. Eat anyway. Keep simple, calorie-dense food accessible (nuts, crackers, energy bars) for when a full meal isn't possible
- **Drink water.** Dehydration amplifies fatigue, headaches, and poor decision-making. Keep a water bottle on your person

- **Shower when you can.** It sounds trivial but hygiene is a morale multiplier. A 3-minute shower between alerts resets your mental state. Use the Before Showering checklist (Section 4.3)
- **Move your body.** Even 10 minutes of stretching or walking around the flat between alerts prevents the physical stiffness that comes from sitting in a shelter
- **Manage medication.** Do not let prescriptions lapse. Pharmacies may be disrupted — maintain a 72-hour buffer at all times

Psychological:

- **Limit news consumption.** Check official sources every 1–3 hours (per Section 3.7), but do NOT doom-scroll. Constant news exposure increases anxiety without improving your safety
- **Maintain routines.** Even small ones: morning coffee, a meal at the table, reading to your children before bed. Routine is psychologically stabilising
- **Stay connected.** Talk to family, friends, neighbours. Isolation amplifies stress. Check on elderly neighbours
- **Acknowledge the difficulty.** "This is hard" is not weakness. Sustained threat exposure is genuinely difficult. Name it
- **Watch for warning signs** in yourself and family: persistent insomnia, inability to eat, withdrawal, rage at small things, numbness, children regressing (bedwetting, clinginess, nightmares). These are normal stress responses, but if they persist, call ERAN (1201) or NATAL (1-800-363-363)
- **Children need extra reassurance** during protracted conflict. Maintain bedtime routines. Let them talk about what they feel. Don't dismiss fears — validate and redirect: "Yes, it's scary. And we have a plan, and our safe room works, and we're together"
- **Give yourself permission to function imperfectly.** Productivity will be lower. Patience will be thinner. Housework will slide. That's fine. The priority is safety, then wellbeing, then everything else

Practical:

- **Rotate responsibilities** with your partner or household members. One person should not be solely responsible for readiness, children, and supplies for weeks on end
- **Restock proactively.** Do not wait until supplies are empty. When the situation is calm, go out and resupply water, food, batteries, and medications. See Section 4.5 (Before Leaving Home)
- **Keep a routine for the checklist.** PAWS BED in the morning. Situational checklists as needed. This is not busywork — it is the structure that keeps you safe when your motivation fades

5.8 Caring for Elderly Neighbours & Vulnerable People

During wartime, the people most at risk are those who cannot help themselves: elderly people living alone, people with disabilities, people with limited mobility, and those without strong social networks.

Before the escalation (ideally during routine):

- **Know your neighbours.** Especially those living alone, elderly, or with mobility limitations. Introduce yourself if you haven't already
- **Exchange phone numbers.** A simple "Can I have your number in case of emergency?" can save a life
- **Establish a buddy system.** Agree to check on each other after every alert. This is especially critical for people who cannot reach shelter independently
- **Offer a spare key** or know who holds one, in case they are injured or trapped inside

During alerts:

- If you know an elderly or mobility-limited neighbour cannot reach shelter alone, **check on them on your way** — but only if it doesn't put your own household at risk
- If they cannot move, help them to the safest position in their flat: inner wall, away from windows, below window line
- After the all-clear, **knock on their door.** A simple "Are you OK?" takes 10 seconds

Ongoing support during protracted conflict:

- Check that they have **food, water, and medications.** Elderly people may not be able to resupply themselves, especially if mobility is limited or streets feel unsafe
- Help with **technology.** Ensure their phone is charged, HFC app is configured (see Appendix A), and they understand how alerts work
- **Offer to include them** in your supply runs. "I'm going to the shops — do you need anything?" is one of the most valuable things you can say
- If they are showing signs of distress (confusion, not eating, withdrawal), contact welfare services: 118 (Welfare Ministry) or *8840 (Senior Citizens line)

5.9 Using Communal / Public Shelters

Public shelters (miklat tziburi / מקלט ציבורי) and institutional protected spaces (mamam / ממ"מ) serve buildings and neighbourhoods that lack private mamads. Familiarise yourself with them **before** you need them.

> ⚠️ **Official guidance:** The Home Front Command maintains information about public shelters and their locations. Check the HFC app or visit oref.org.il for the most current and authoritative information about shelters in your area. The guidance below supplements — but does not replace — official HFC instructions.

Finding your shelters:

- Use the HFC app to locate nearby shelters
- Ask your building committee (vaad bayit), neighbours, or municipality
- Physically walk to your nearest 3 shelters and verify you can access them (Section 3.7)

Access issues (common):

- Many public shelters are **locked.** Find out who holds the key — building committee, municipality, or a designated keyholder
- Some shelters have **restricted hours** or require a code
- Some are used as **storage** and may be partially blocked — report this to your municipality
- If the shelter is locked during an alert and you cannot reach the keyholder, the municipality emergency line (106–109) may be able to help

Etiquette and safety in communal shelters:

- **Make space.** Move to the back or sides once inside to allow others in
- **Priority access:** children, elderly, pregnant women, people with disabilities
- **Keep noise down.** Others are frightened. Loud phone calls and arguments increase panic
- **Share resources** if someone arrives without supplies — water, a phone charger, a blanket
- **Do not bring large items** that block floor space. Your go bag is fine. A suitcase is not
- **Pets:** many public shelters do **not** allow animals. Check in advance. If your shelter does not, have an alternative plan (Section 5.1 of SOP-15 in the companion SOPs repo)
- **Hygiene:** shelters can be crowded and poorly ventilated. Wear a mask (N95 from your go bag) if you prefer. Wash hands when you leave

- **Children:** bring something for them to do. Long waits in a concrete room are hard on kids

After the all-clear:

- Take all your belongings with you
- Report any damage or maintenance issues to the municipality
- If the shelter was dirty, locked improperly, or unusable, report it — you're improving it for next time

5.10 OPSEC & Information Discipline

During wartime, what you share online can endanger lives — including your own.

Do NOT share:

- **Exact locations of impacts or landings.** Not on WhatsApp, not on X, not on Telegram, not on Instagram stories. Enemy forces monitor social media in real time to calibrate targeting. A photo of "where it landed near my house" tells them exactly where to aim next
- **Locations of military or emergency service activity** — troop movements, ambulance staging areas, Iron Dome battery positions, emergency service response times
- **Photos or videos of damage** that reveal identifiable locations (street signs, building numbers, landmarks)
- **Information about casualties** before families have been notified. This is both an OPSEC issue and a basic human decency issue

Do NOT believe:

- **Unverified reports on X (Twitter), Telegram, or WhatsApp groups.** These platforms are flooded with misinformation during conflict — some accidental, some deliberate. Adversaries actively seed false information to cause panic, misdirect, and demoralise
- **"Breaking" news from accounts you don't recognise.** Wait for official confirmation
- **Dramatic claims** ("massive attack incoming", "ceasefire confirmed", "city evacuated") that don't come from IDF Spokesperson, HFC, Israel Police, or established media
- **Screenshots of alerts** from unverified sources — real HFC alerts come through the app and official channels, not WhatsApp forwards

Do:

- Get your information from **official sources**: HFC app, IDF Spokesperson, Israel Police, established news outlets (Kan, Ynet, Times of Israel, etc.)

- **Check before you share.** Ask: Is this from a verified official source? Could sharing this endanger someone? Is it actually useful?
- If you see friends or family sharing sensitive location information, **tell them to delete it.** Be direct — "Delete that, it shows where it landed" is not rude, it's responsible
- Report disinformation to platform moderation where possible
- Remember that even **positive** unverified rumours ("they shot down everything, we're fine") are harmful — they create false security and undermine trust in real information

> *Even well-intentioned sharing can be lethal OPSEC. When in doubt, don't post.*

5.11 Preliminary Guidelines (Advance Warning)

The HFC operates a **preliminary guideline** system for attacks originating from distant sources (e.g. Yemen). This provides a **3–5 minute advance warning** before the actual Red Alert sounds.

What it means:

- You will receive a notification via the HFC app *before* the siren sounds
- The preliminary guideline does **NOT** require you to enter a shelter
- It means: prepare. Put shoes on. Locate your phone. Know where you're going. Be ready to move the moment the actual alert sounds

What to do:

- If at home: ensure shoes, keys, phone, go bag are in position. Move children to a central area. Be ready
- If driving: start looking for a solid building to pull over near. Do not stop on a bridge or in a tunnel
- If on a bus/train: train may slow to 30 km/h and passengers may be asked to bend below window line. Follow crew instructions
- If outside with children: identify the nearest shelter or solid building. Gather children close

When the actual alert sounds: follow standard shelter procedure (Appendix D). The preliminary guideline bought you preparation time — use it.

5.12 Terrorist Infiltration / Hostile Aerial Vehicle

This is a **different protocol** from rocket/missile response. Do NOT follow the standard shelter procedure.

When you hear an infiltration alert or suspect a terror event:

1. **Enter the nearest building** immediately
2. **Lock the door.** Use a heavy object to barricade if needed
3. **Turn lights off.** Stay in darkness
4. **Stay silent.** Turn off TV, radio, and anything that makes noise
5. **Sit below window line.** Stay away from windows and exterior walls
6. **Do NOT share your location on social media.** Attackers monitor social media in real time
7. **Do NOT open the door** for anyone except identified security forces
8. **If a rocket alert sounds during an infiltration: stay where you are.** Do NOT leave to go to a stairwell or shelter — remaining locked and hidden takes priority over the standard shelter protocol
9. **Wait for security forces** to announce the all-clear. This may take hours. Do not assume it is safe because it has been quiet

Mamad door during infiltration:

- Do NOT remove the mamad door handle to prevent entry — this damages the mechanism
- Instead, use a heavy object to block the door from inside

Licensed weapon holders:

- Aim at the front door. Fire only on positive identification of a threat. Do not fire blindly through doors or walls

5.13 Shabbat / Hag (Observant Jews)

ITEM	CHECK
Channel 14 / Gal Shaket	☐ PLAYING ☐ VOLUME TEST - Verify TV not muted
Emergency Radio	☐ **FREQUENCY AND OPERATION VERIFIED** ☐ **VOLUME TEST** - Device is on full volume ☐ **POWER SUPPLY** - AC connected or sufficient batteries
Shabbat Supplies	☐ **PACKED** - If bringing to shelter

Appendix A: Home Front Command App (Android)

ITEM	CHECK
INSTALLED	☐ VERIFIED
UP TO DATE	☐ VERIFIED - No pending updates uninstalled
ALERTING AREA	☐ SET and IDENTIFIED
PERMISSIONS	☐ DND EXEMPTION - VERIFIED ☐ REMOVE PERMISSIONS IF UNUSED - Disabled ☐ BATTERY OPTIMISATIONS - DISABLED ☐ BACKGROUND DATA ACCESS - PERMITTED ☐ DISPLAY OVER OTHER APPS - GRANTED

Appendix B: Emergency Numbers

NUMBER	SERVICE	NOTES
100	Israel Police	Unexploded ordnance, security incidents, terror events *(SMS: 052-2020100)*
101	Magen David Adom (MDA)	Injuries, first aid, medical emergencies *(SMS: 052-7000101)*
102	Fire & Rescue	Fires, trapped persons, structural collapse *(SMS: 050-5960735)*
103	Electric Corp.	Power outages, electrical hazards *(SMS: 055-7000103)*
104	Home Front Command	Guidelines, alerts, emergency information *(SMS: 052-9104104)*
106–109	Municipality	Local information, municipal assistance
110	Police Info	Road blocks, police information hotline

SUPPORT & WELFARE	
118	Welfare Ministry - Information and assistance
1201	ERAN - Emotional first aid hotline
***8840**	Senior Citizens - Ministry of Social Equality
***9696**	

SUPPORT & WELFARE	
	National Insurance - Counselling for elderly and families
105	Missing persons hotline
1-800-363-363	NATAL - Trauma support
03-6919765	NAAN - Youth crisis line
***4954**	Tax Authority - War property damage compensation claims
1-700-707-889	Population Authority - Foreign workers assistance
04-7702651	Immigration assistance (English)

> ☐ **PRINTED COPY** of emergency numbers posted at home (fridge / front door) and in go bag. Do NOT rely on phone contacts alone.

Appendix C: Mamad (Protected Space) Inspection

Based on Home Front Command (Pikud HaOref) guidelines for residential protected spaces.

MAMAD - STRUCTURAL INSPECTION	
Blast Door	☐ **OPENS AND CLOSES** easily ☐ **HANDLE** turns 90° upward ☐ **DOUBLE LOCK** functions
Door Seal	☐ **RUBBER INSULATION** present and not dried out or cracked *(replace if brittle)*
Light Test	☐ **NO LIGHT PENETRATION** when door is sealed *(light = inadequate seal)*
Steel Outer Window	☐ **OPENS AND CLOSES** easily
Glass Inner Window	☐ **FUNCTIONS CORRECTLY** - Single-wing: verify both locks engage. Double-wing: **remove both wings** during escalation periods and store outside room *(they cannot seal properly when closed)*
Ventilation Pipes	☐ **RUBBER INSULATION INTACT** ☐ **STEEL COVER SCREWS** tighten fully

MAMAD - CONTENTS & SAFETY	
Flammable / Hazardous	☐ **NONE** - No flammable, hazardous, or toxic materials stored inside
Glass / Ceramics	☐ **NONE** - No glass, ceramic, or porcelain items that could shatter *(no mirrors, vases, ceramic decorations)*
Heavy Items	☐ **SHELVES AND HEAVY ITEMS** fixed to walls - nothing that can fall during impact
Gas Tanks	☐ **3+ METRES** from protected room walls *(report violations to gas company and local authority)*
Emergency Supplies	☐ **STORED INSIDE** or immediately nearby
Ceiling Fan	☐ **NONE INSTALLED** - Ceiling fans are prohibited in mamads *(may endanger occupants during attack)*
Ventilation	☐ **ROOM IS VENTILATED** if used as bedroom - Mamad must NOT be used as kitchen, bathroom, or washroom

Appendix D: Protected Space Decision Tree (Siren Response)

When a Red Alert sounds, choose the highest-priority option you can reach within the time available. Do NOT leave your protected space until the all-clear is received.

> ⚠️ **WHEN TO LEAVE:** Stay in your protected space for **10 minutes OR until you receive an all-clear notification** from HFC (via app, siren pattern, or official media) — whichever comes later. During active operations, HFC issues specific all-clear notifications. If you have no connectivity, default to staying put (see Section 5.2).
>
> **Siren duration = defense time.** The length of the siren tells you how long you have to reach shelter. If the siren is 90 seconds, you have 90 seconds. Border areas may have 15 seconds or less.

```
RED ALERT SOUNDS → Go to protected space

    1. Do you have a MAMAD / MAMAK / MAMAM?
       ├── YES → PRIORITY 1: MAMAD
       │         Close blast door (handle 90°)
```

```
       │         Close steel + glass windows
       │         Sit against inner wall
       │         ★ WAIT FOR ALL-CLEAR
       │
       └── NO ↓

    2. Can you reach a SHELTER within the time available?
       ├── YES → PRIORITY 2: SHELTER
       │         Building shelter or public shelter
       │         Enter and close the door
       │         ★ WAIT FOR ALL-CLEAR
       │
       └── NO ↓

    3. Does your building have an INNER STAIRWELL
       (no windows or exterior walls)?
       ├── YES → PRIORITY 3: STAIRWELL
       │         Stay in the CENTRE — not top floor, not ground
floor
       │         Stay on staircase, not in hallway
       │         ★ WAIT FOR ALL-CLEAR
       │
       └── NO ↓

    4. Is there an INNER ROOM with maximum walls
       and minimum windows?
       ├── YES → PRIORITY 4: INNER ROOM
       │         Sit against inner wall, below window line
       │         Not facing door. Close all doors.
       │         ★ WAIT FOR ALL-CLEAR
       │
       └── NO ↓

    5. PRIORITY 5: LAST RESORT
       Lie flat on the ground.
       Protect your head with your hands.
       ★ WAIT FOR ALL-CLEAR
```

⛔ **NOT valid protected spaces:** Kitchen · Bathroom · Toilet · Building entrance lobby · Caravans / prefab structures · Areas with ceramics, porcelain, or glass that could shatter

Stairwell positioning: 3+ floors: at least 2 floors above you. 3-storey building: middle floor only. Stay on the staircase, not in the hallway.

Appendix E: Hebrew Glossary

Key terms you will hear on the news, in alerts, and from neighbours. Knowing these words can save critical seconds.

HEBREW	TRANSLITERATION	MEANING
אזעקה	**Azaka**	Alert / siren
צבע אדום	**Tzeva Adom**	"Red Color" — the Red Alert warning
ממ״ד	**Mamad**	Apartment-level protected space (merkhav mugan dirati)
ממ״ק	**Mamak**	Floor-level protected space (merkhav mugan komati)
ממ״מ	**Mamam**	Institutional / public building protected space (merkhav mugan musdee)
מקלט	**Miklat**	Public bomb shelter
חדר מדרגות	**Khadar Madregot**	Stairwell
פיקוד העורף	**Pikud HaOref**	Home Front Command (HFC)
התרעה מקדימה	**Hatra'a Makdima**	Preliminary guideline (advance warning)
הנחיה מיוחדת	**Hankhaya Meyukhedet**	Special instruction
ירי רקטות	**Yeri Raketot**	Rocket fire
חדירת כלי טיס עוין	**Khadirat Kli Tis Oyein**	Hostile aerial vehicle infiltration
חדירת מחבלים	**Khadirat Mekhabblim**	Terrorist infiltration
רעידת אדמה	**Re'idat Adama**	Earthquake
חומרים מסוכנים	**Khomarim Mesukanim**	Hazardous materials
ניתן לצאת	**Nitan Latzeit**	"You may exit" — all-clear
היכנסו למרחב המוגן	**Hikansu LaMerkhav HaMugan**	"Enter the protected space"
שהו במרחב המוגן	**Shehu BaMerkhav HaMugan**	"Remain in the protected space"
דלת פלדה	**Delet Plada**	Steel/blast door
חלון פלדה	**Khalon Plada**	Steel window
תריס	**Tris**	Shutter
פנס	**Panas**	Torch / flashlight
תיק חירום	**Tik Kherum**	Emergency bag (go bag)
מד״א	**Mada**	Magen David Adom (ambulance/first aid)

HEBREW	TRANSLITERATION	MEANING
צה"ל	**Tzahal**	IDF (Israel Defense Forces)
משטרה	**Mishtara**	Police
כבאות	**Kaba'ut**	Fire service
ועד בית	**Va'ad Bayit**	Building committee
עורף	**Oref**	Home front (civilian rear)

Appendix F: Emergency Radio Frequencies

If phone and internet are down, a battery-powered or hand-crank AM/FM radio is your lifeline. Pre-set these frequencies.

STATION	FM (MHz)	AM (kHz)	NOTES
Kol Israel Reshet Bet (כאן ב')	95.5 / 97.8	657 / 1206	Primary national news; official HFC announcements broadcast here
Galei Tzahal (גלצ)	102.3 / 103.0	—	IDF Radio; security updates and official statements
Kol Israel Reshet Aleph (כאן א')	100.3 / 104.0	531 / 1008	National talk and news
Kol Israel Reshet Gimel (כאן ג')	97.0 / 99.0	—	Hebrew music + news bulletins
Kol Israel Arabic (כאן בערבית)	99.5	576 / 711	Arabic-language news and alerts
Kol Israel Reka (כאן רק"ע)	101.5 / 104.5	972	Russian/Amharic/French/ English news

> **Notes:**
>
> - FM frequencies vary by region. The frequencies above are approximate; scan nearby if no signal
> - **AM is more reliable** during emergencies — longer range, less affected by infrastructure damage, works inside buildings better than FM
> - During emergencies, all stations simulcast HFC announcements

> - **Write your local frequencies on the radio itself** with a permanent marker

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Disclaimer

This document is **not an official government resource**. It is a community-authored field guide compiled by Daniel Rosehill with AI assistance, based on publicly available guidance from the Israel Home Front Command (Pikud HaOref / פיקוד העורף).

Grounding source: This guide was systematically cross-referenced against official HFC guidance pages from oref.org.il (English-language National Emergency Portal), archived on **20 March 2026**. Source HTML files are preserved in the `sources/hfc-official/` directory of this repository.

Always defer to official instructions from HFC, the IDF, Israel Police, and local authorities. In the event of any conflict between this document and official guidance, follow official guidance.

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Official source: oref.org.il | **HFC Hotline:** 104

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